BUSINESS OPPORTUNITY AND BUSINESS IDEAS

Entrepreneurial opportunities are not equally obvious to everyone but are equally available to anyone with the experiences and knowledge to discover them. Opportunities are themselves unstructured where advantages and disadvantages of opportunities are largely dependent on individual differences in terms of personal experience, exposure, and training.

Business Opportunity: A business opportunity may be described as an attractive proposition that provides the possibility of a return for the investor **or** the person taking the risk.

Business Ideas: This is a matter of conception which is a perceived or conscious thought of activity that may yield a return if carried out. It represents an investment opportunity that could lead to the creation of venture (s)

Characteristics of a Good Business Opportunity

To be a good business idea to be considered as a business opportunity, it must fulfil or be capable of fulfilling the following criteria;

a. Real demand
b. Return on Investment
c. Competitiveness
d. Veritable objectives
e. Availability of resources and skills

Generating Business Ideas

Sequel to the above, a good business idea could be generated by sincerely and objectively answering these questions

a. What product or service do you think as a business will sell?
b. Who are the potential customers?
c. Where is the intended location of your business?
d. Which need do you want to fulfil?
e. When do you intend to launch the product or service?
f. How do you want to market the product or service?

It is a general belief that these questions will enable you to sift different ideas and get a viable business idea worthy of investing upon.

Sources of Business Ideas

There are millions of entrepreneurs throughout the world wherein their testimonies suggest that there are many potential and various sources of business ideas. Below are some of the sources although the list is inexhaustive;

a. Hobbies
b. Personal skills and experience
c. Mass media
d. Exhibitions
e. Surveys
f. Franchise
g. Social interaction & engagement
h. Deliberate research
i. Brainstorming

Indicators of Business Ideas and Opportunities

The following can serve as good indicators of business ideas for business opportunities;

a. Poor product quality
b. Lack of supportive services
c. Overpriced product
d. Existence of monopoly
e. Change in technology
f. Product failure
g. Need for a product
h. Market trends and expansion

Factor Facilitating Business Ideas and Opportunities

The presence of the following elements in a business environment could fast-track or act as a catalyst for facilitating business ideas;

a. Population
b. Infrastructural facilities
c. Education/exposure
d. Government policies
e. Business opportunity
f. Achievement motive drive
g. Skills and experience
h. Endowed talents

Entrepreneurial Environment

The environment is considered the surroundings of business and has been described as the place where an entrepreneur conducts business. It has a significant effect on the operation and nature of business.

Classification of Entrepreneurial Environment

This environment will be classified into two i.e., internal (within the organisation) and external (outside of the organisation)

We also have

a. Stable environment
b. Turbulent environment
c. Volatile environment
d. Dynamic environment and
e. Slowly evolving environment

FINANCIAL ASPECT OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Finance is the management of money resource for a specific purpose by individuals, corporate bodies, and government. It is often a critical component to the business's success.

Classification of Sources of Entrepreneurial Financing

The sources of entrepreneurial financing can be classified into three main groups i.e., short-term, medium-term, and long-term financing

Short-term is usually between 0 – 12 months which can be under any of these friends and relatives, cooperatives, trade credits, overdrafts, factoring, acceptance credits etc.,

Medium-term is usually between 1 – 2 years and can be one of these commercial banks, hire purchase, leasing etc.,

Long-term is usually 3 years and above and can be one of these debentures, preference shares, ordinary shares, retained earnings etc.,

E-COMMERCE

E-commerce is the abbreviation of electronic commerce. It is the buying and selling of products and services online. It can involve transactions between individuals, businesses, households, or private organizations. E-commerce can include ordering goods and services, buying financial investments, confirming travel and accommodation reservations, paying for internet information services, and buying through online auctions.

The Internet service is the foundation and critical to e-commerce activities. The Internet allows individuals and businesses to buy and sell an increasing amount of physical goods, digital goods, and services electronically.

How does ecommerce work?

Ecommerce works by connecting sellers with customers and allowing exchanges to take place online. It can work in many different ways and take many forms. Here's a general overview of how the process can look:

1. The seller chooses online selling channels, like a website or social media, and promotes products or services for sale.
2. Customers find the products or services and place orders.
3. A payment processor enables the exchange of the goods or services electronically via payment options like credit cards or digital currencies.
4. The customer receives a confirmation email or SMS along with a printable receipt.
5. If the transaction is for goods, the seller ships the products and sends the customer a tracking number via email or SMS. If the transaction is for a service, the service provider can reach out to schedule and complete the service.

Types of E-Commerce

E-commerce takes as many different forms as there are various ways to interact with online channels. For example, sellers and buyers exchange goods and services through m-commerce, enterprise commerce, and social selling destinations

A few common business models are:

- **B2C:** Businesses sell to individual consumers, sometimes called the "end customer."
- **B2B:** Businesses sell to other businesses. Often the buyer resells products to the consumer.
- **C2B:** Consumers sell to businesses. C2B businesses allow customers to sell to other companies.
- **C2C:** Consumers sell to other consumers. Businesses create online shopping destinations to connect customers.
- **B2G:** Businesses sell to governments or government agencies.

- **C2G**: Consumers sell to governments or government agencies.
- **G2B:** Governments or government agencies sell to businesses.
- **G2C:** Governments or government agencies sell to consumers.

FOUR Cs of E-Commerce

The 4Cs of e-commerce are

a. Commerce
b. Content
c. Connectivity
d. Communication

Steps in E-Commerce Business

The steps to starting an ecommerce business can vary depending on factors like what you want to sell. For example, if you're selling services, then there's no need to manage inventory or fulfillment. However, if you want to sell products online, then inventory and fulfillment will likely play a critical part in your operations.

Here are some steps you can follow to get started:

1. Research business ideas.
2. Make sure there's demand for the products you want to sell.
3. Determine how you'll sell and ship products to customers.
4. Find suppliers and manufacturers.
5. Choose which online channels you'll sell through.
6. Create a website or online storefront and list products.
7. Create a plan for your fulfillment strategy.
8. Begin attracting customers with promotions

Benefits of e-commerce

Below are some of the benefits of e-commerce

1. Accessibility and convenience
2. Direct access to customers
3. Global marketing reach
4. Relatively low operating costs
5. Advances in technology

Challenges of e-commerce

Aside from the above benefits, here are some of the challenges of e-commerce

1. High competition
2. Limited interaction with customers and products
3. Shipping and fulfillment at scale
4. Reliance on technology
5. Data security concerns

ENTREPRENEURSHIP INNOVATION

Entrepreneurship innovation is synonymous with Joseph Schumpeter through his work on destructive creativity. Innovation in entrepreneurship means the practice of creating new business ideas and plans with the intention of generating profits, helping the community, and accompanying company goals i.e., the art of implementing new ideas, strategies, and thought processes with a vision to introduce or improve the present.

In the long run, in order for a business to survive and grow, innovating a product or service becomes a crucial step, and as observed and experienced innovation in any business helps an entrepreneur to improve or restore a particular product, process, or service.

Who is an Innovative Entrepreneur?

An innovative entrepreneur is a person who has the potential of designing and bringing innovative products into the market. Innovative entrepreneur in the name itself reflects a responsibility over a person's shoulder to generate and bring new ideas into business which can later be converted into life-changing products.

Innovative entrepreneurs design business models to meet the corporate needs of businesses and improve their competitiveness in the market. Innovative entrepreneurs are individuals with innovative ideas to create long-lasting solutions for common problems shared by a large number of people or countries

The Importance of Innovative Entrepreneurship

It's important to have innovative entrepreneurship because

1. It helps to identify new trends and market demand.
2. It helps a company to produce new goods or services that appeal to its target audience.
3. It helps to adapt to new trends in its industry.
4. It helps to create innovative products, services or up to date brand development to stay relevant.

Traits of Innovative Entrepreneurs

Some successful innovative entrepreneurs have specific personality traits that contribute to their innovative ways of thinking. Personality traits for a successful innovative entrepreneur can include:

1. They're patient
2. They're proactive
3. They're excellent communicators
4. They're determined to find solutions to challenges
5. They're okay with change